



BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE
Pilani Campus
AUGS/ AGSR Division

FIRST SEMESTER 2026-2027

Course Handout (Part II)

Date: 28/07/2026

In addition to Part-I (General Handout for all courses appended to the timetable), this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course Number : HSS F221
Course Title : Readings from Drama
Instructor In-Charge : PRATEEK
[Team of Instructors] : N/A

1. Course description:

Drama as a distinct genre; History of drama; Performance and stagecraft; Evolution of drama from a theocentric to a logocentric plane; Distinct characteristics of Western and non-Western dramas; Aristotle's Poetics and the genre of tragedy; Bharat Muni's *Natyashastra* and the idea of comedy; Adaptation of myths as Drama; Modern drama.

2. Scope and Objective:

The objective of the course is to introduce students to different types and forms of drama. In doing so, this course will familiarize students with various dramatic forms spanning different geographical spaces and time, thereby helping them to have a deeper understanding of the same. It will also enable the students to connect various dramatic forms through the study of visuals, timelines, and biographical and contextual readings that allow them to delve further into the history and conventions of the time period when these dramatic works were produced.

3. Course learning outcomes:

- 1) Understand and analyze various dramatic forms keeping in mind recent trends and theoretical underpinnings.
- 2) Apply acquired knowledge in critically appreciating dramatic texts and performances.
- 3) Exhibit methodological proficiency to formulate research problems and write research papers.

4. Text books and references:

- TB-1** J. Ellen Gainor et al. *The Norton Anthology of Drama (2 Vols.)* New York: W.W. Norton & Company, 2013.
- TB-2** P. Lal. *Great Sanskrit Plays in Modern Translation*. New Delhi: New Directions, 1964.
- TB-3** G.P. Deshpande. *Modern Indian Drama: An Anthology*. New Delhi: Sahitya Akademi, 2004.

We will pick from the following dramas:



Consider Your Environmental Responsibilities
Do Not Print Unless Necessary



BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE
Pilani Campus
AUGS/ AGSR Division

1. Euripides' *Medea*
2. *Everyman*
3. Christopher Marlowe's *Doctor Faustus*
4. Shakespeare's *As You Like It*
5. Shakespeare's *Hamlet*
6. W.B. Yeats' *Cathleen Ni Houlihan*
7. St. John Ervine's *Progress*
8. Henrik Ibsen's *A Doll's House/An Enemy of the People*
9. Sanskrit Plays in Translation: *Shakuntala*
10. Indian Play: Girish Karnad's *Nagamandala*
11. Saoli Mitra's *Five Lords yet None a Protector*
12. Inua Ellams' *Barber Shop Chronicles*
13. Rajiv Joseph's *Guards at the Taj*
14. Lucas Hnath's *A Doll's House, Part 2*
15. Bernard Shaw's *Pygmalion*

5. [Method of conduct of the course]: Lectures

6. Course Plan

Module No.	Lecture Session	Reference to	Learning Outcomes
1-3	Introduction to Drama: Forms and Characteristics	Reading Material	Understanding the basic structure of drama and its constituents.
4-6	Evolution of European Drama from Classical Time to Renaissance: An Overview of History	Reading Material	Knowing the background of European drama and how it has evolved.
7-8	Workshop	Class Notes	Common strategies to analyze dramatic performance; Understanding Structuralism and analyzing the drama from a Structuralist point of view
9-13	Euripides and <i>Medea</i> Background and detail analysis of the play	TB-1	Understanding the Greek idea of drama; Analyzing the classical ideals of time and tragedy;
14-15	Morality Play: A European Perspective	Class Notes	Understanding the aesthetics of morality play
16-20	<i>Everyman</i> : Background and detail analysis of the play	TB-1	Analyzing <i>Everyman</i> based on the European ideals of morality plays.



BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE
Pilani Campus
AUGS/ AGSR Division

Module No.	Lecture Session	Reference to	Learning Outcomes
21-22	Domestic Drama: Meanings and Perspectives	Class Notes	Understanding how modernity has shaped drama
23-27	Henrik Ibsen and <i>A Doll's House</i> : Background and detailed analysis of the play	TB-1	Analyzing Ibsen as a dramatist of domestic drama; understanding the difference between Greek tragedy and modern tragedy
28-29	History of Indian Drama: Sanskrit Plays to Modern Drama	Class Notes	Knowing the background of Indian drama and how it has evolved
30-34	Indian Plays: Background and Analysis of the Play/s and their Creators	TB-2	Understanding the nuances and background of Sanskrit/modern Indian plays; analyzing the messages they disseminate
35-36	African Theatre with a particular focus on Nigeria	Class Notes	Analyzing different types of African Theatre
37-41	<i>Barber Shop Chronicles</i> : Background and analysis of the play	Reading Material	Engaging with the nuances of African theatre.
42	Summing up		

7. Evaluation Scheme:

Component	Duration	Weightage (%)	Date & Time	Remarks
Class Assignment (1)	45 mins	15	-to be announced-	CB
Assignment 2	-	20	-to be announced-	OB
Mid-Sem Test	90 mins	30	-As per the AUGSD schedule-	OB
Comprehensive	3 hours	35	-As per the AUGSD schedule-	OB

Criterion for NC: As per the AUGSD guidelines



Consider Your Environmental Responsibilities
Do Not Print Unless Necessary



BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE
Pilani Campus
AUGS/ AGSR Division

- 8. Chamber consultation hours:** 3 pm to 4 pm (Thursday).
- 9. Makeup Policy:** As per the AUGSD guidelines
- 10. Attendance Policy:** Students are required to attend and participate in classes.

Dr Prateek
Instructor In-charge
HSS F221